EXPERIMENT 14

PRO-CODE EXTENSION USING ZOHO CATALYST

AIM

To understand how Zoho Catalyst can extend a low-code Zoho Creator application with custom services and pro-code functionality.

DESCRIPTION

Introduction

Low-code platforms simplify application development, but some requirements need custom backend logic, specialized APIs, or more control over processing. Zoho Catalyst is a developer platform for building and running cloud applications and services. It can complement Zoho Creator when a requirement is better handled outside the low-code application.

When an extension is useful

A library application might need a custom recommendation service, advanced document processing, scheduled data processing, or a specialized integration. Such features can be implemented in a suitable Catalyst service and called from Zoho Creator through an authenticated API.

Possible architecture

Zoho Creator can remain responsible for user-facing forms, reports, and routine workflows. A Catalyst component can perform a specialized task and return a response. The integration typically involves defining an API contract, configuring authentication, sending a request, handling the response, and logging failures.

Implementation approach

First define the requirement and the request and response data. Build and test the Catalyst service using the supported runtime and deployment workflow. Configure authentication and permissions. Then call the service from Zoho Creator using a supported connection or Deluge integration method. The exact setup depends on the Catalyst service type and current product features.

Error handling and security

Validate incoming data, reject unauthorized requests, protect credentials, and avoid sending unnecessary personal information. Handle timeouts, unsuccessful HTTP status

codes, and malformed responses. Add monitoring and logs, and test both successful and failed requests.

Testing and maintenance

Test the Catalyst service independently before connecting it to Creator. Verify the full flow using test data, document the API contract, and plan for version changes. Monitor latency, failures, usage, and costs as the solution grows.

Design considerations

Use Creator for standard forms and workflows when it is sufficient. Add Catalyst only where it provides a clear benefit, because an extra service adds deployment, security, monitoring, and maintenance responsibilities.

RESULT

The role of Zoho Catalyst as a pro-code extension to Zoho Creator was studied. A combined architecture can keep routine application features in Creator while delegating specialized processing to an authenticated external service.